

Effectiveness of a Generate–Verify–Repair Pipeline with Batfish for LLM-Generated Vendor CLI Configurations

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Abstract—We report a preregistered paired experiment (cnsms2026-001-gvr-batfish-prereg-v1) that evaluated whether a generate–verify–repair (GVR) pipeline—shared initial LLM candidate (gpt-5-mini) + a deterministic Batfish-style validator + at most one automated LLM repair—reduces deterministic-verifier detected semantic/safety failures on intent→vendor-CLI tasks. Planned N=300 pairs; 266 complete pairs were analysed after preregistered exclusions. Baseline pass-rate = 260/266 (97.744%); guarded (final GVR) pass-rate = 265/266 (99.624%). Paired difference = 0.01879699248; exact McNemar two-sided $p = 0.0625$. Paired bootstrap (B=10,000, seed=1729) 95% percentile CI = [0.0037593984962406013, 0.03759398496240601]. Repair was invoked for 6 tasks; median repair iterations per task = 0. Per-episode latency was not recorded in per-task artifacts and thus could not be evaluated. Under shared_initial_candidate semantics the observed absolute improvement is small and did not meet the preregistered $\alpha=0.05$ decision rule. We provide preregistered design details, deterministic validator semantics, exact paired counts, representative artifact-grounded repair examples, contamination findings (no exact public duplicates flagged), and a focused discussion of limitations and implications.

I. INTRODUCTION

Generative large language models (LLMs) are actively explored for NetOps tasks such as intent→CLI translation, zero-touch configuration synthesis, and automated maintenance workflows [1], and surveys emphasize both opportunity and risk when LLMs are applied to operational network configuration [2]. Stochastic LLM outputs can produce syntactic or semantic violations—missing required commands, unsafe command orderings, or constraint breaches—that create operational risk if applied directly. To mitigate that risk, pipelines that interpose deterministic verifiers (e.g., Batfish or header-space analyses) and bounded repair loops—collectively generate–verify–repair (GVR)—have been proposed to provide deterministic acceptance criteria and automated correction [3,4]. Prior work presents components and prototypes, but preregistered, paired evaluations that archive verifier traces and quantify verifier-triggered repair benefit on reproducible NetOps task banks remain limited.

This study tested the preregistered question (cnsms2026-001-gvr-batfish-prereg-v1): Does a GVR pipeline that uses a single sampled initial LLM candidate per task (shared_initial_candidate semantics), a deterministic Batfish-style validator, and at most one automated LLM repair call reduce deterministic-verifier detected semantic/safety failures relative to the same initial candidate without repair?

Our principal contribution is a preregistered, artifact-archived paired evaluation executed under the CNSM Agentic AI Researcher constraints that reports exact paired counts, inferential outcomes, execution accounting, representative artifact examples, and an evidence-grounded interpretation.

II. RELATED WORK

Prior work relevant to this study spans (a) applied LLM prototypes and benchmarks for network configuration, (b) surveys documenting LLM failure modes and recommendations to ground generation, (c) proposals for generate–verify–repair and related architectures for deterministic validation, and (d) established deterministic network verification tools that serve as practical oracles in automated pipelines. We synthesize those threads and emphasize aspects most relevant to a preregistered paired GVR evaluation.

LLM-driven NetOps prototypes and benchmarks: Recent system-level and benchmark efforts investigate whether LLMs can aid network configuration generation and automation. NetConfEval and similar task collections examine intent→CLI translation and measure correctness under vendor-dialect constraints; these works provide public task exemplars and motivate reproducible task generators for controlled evaluation [1]. Such benchmark tasks typically encode required command sequences and vendor syntax, which directly map to the validator check types we archive in this study (required-sequence, allowed-field checks, topology reachability). Importantly, prior benchmarks often evaluate single-pass generation accuracy rather than integrated verifier-triggered repair, which motivates the paired GVR design adopted here.

Failure modes, grounding, and mitigation recommendations: Survey and synthesis papers summarize that LLMs commonly produce both syntactic and semantic errors when applied to domain-constrained tasks: missing commands, incorrect ordering, and hallucinated or unsafe modifications [2]. Those surveys recommend grounding strategies (retrieval, tool use), constrained generation, and verifier insertion to reduce the operational risk of accepting model outputs without deterministic checks. Our work adopts those prescriptions by interposing a deterministic validator and bounding the repair loop to one automated correction attempt, aligning experimentally with the practical mitigations advocated in the literature.

Generate–verify–repair and bounded repair proposals: The idea of interposing deterministic oracles and using closed-loop

repair is well established in proposals for regulated or safety-sensitive domains. Convergent GVR architectures aim to combine stochastic generation with deterministic acceptance criteria and limited repair to achieve practical correctness guarantees while preserving the generative model’s productivity [3]. These proposals emphasize publishing verifier traces and repair prompts so that corrected outputs are auditable—an archival design we implemented in the execution artifacts (validator traces, `repair_prompt_sha256`, repair provider traces).

Deterministic network verifiers as oracles and their coverage limits: Tools like Batfish and header-space analyses provide deterministic, rule-based checks for reachability, ordering, and configuration invariants and have been incorporated into research prototypes that integrate model outputs with formal validation [4]. Batfish-style validators excel at expressing and mechanically checking reachability and required-sequence constraints on modeled topologies; however, their guarantees are strictly limited to the rule battery they encode. This distinction matters experimentally: a verifier that checks an explicit finite set of syntactic/semantic invariants yields a binary pass/fail endpoint that is reproducible and auditable, but it cannot detect semantic failures outside its coverage. Our deterministic `netops_validator_v5` follows this same engineering trade-off (syntactic parsing, required-sequence checks, allowed-fields enforcement, and topology reachability), and we archive per-episode validation_before/after traces so readers can inspect exactly which rules were exercised on each episode.

What LLMs need to synthesize correct router configurations and constrained decoding: Empirical studies analyzing LLM difficulty with router configuration point to sequencing, vendor-specific syntax, and dependency constraints as recurring challenges [5]. These analyses motivate two complementary mitigations: (1) stronger first-pass constraints or constrained decoding to reduce syntactic/format errors, and (2) verifier-triggered repair to correct semantic violations that slip through first pass. Our study deliberately fixes the initial candidate (`shared_initial_candidate`) and thereby isolates the marginal effect of the verifier-triggered repair step rather than conflating improvements due to constrained first-pass prompting or multiple draws.

Gaps in prior evaluations that motivated this study: The supplied literature shows active proposals and component evaluations but comparatively fewer preregistered, paired experiments that (i) use `shared_initial_candidate` semantics to measure the isolated effect of bounded repair, (ii) archive raw model traces together with deterministic validator traces and repair provider traces for each episode, and (iii) apply explicit exclusion, retry, and contamination rules in a confirmatory design. Those gaps motivated our preregistered paired design and the artifact-heavy archival choices (manifested in the execution and analysis artifacts we publish alongside this manuscript).

Methodologically relevant syntheses for experimental design: From the surveyed and prototyped prior work we derived three concrete design choices: (1) use a deterministic validator

battery (Batfish-style) to obtain an auditable binary endpoint; (2) bound the repair loop (≤ 1 automated repair call per failed candidate) to maintain a clear paired estimand under `shared_initial_candidate` semantics; and (3) preregister explicit missingness, retry, and contamination treatments to avoid post hoc analytic choices. Each of these choices has precedent or justification in the cited literature: verifiers as deterministic oracles [4], GVR architectures for regulated settings [3], and benchmark/task construction recommendations that emphasize reproducibility and contamination controls [1,2].

In sum, our related-work synthesis locates this study at the intersection of applied intent→CLI benchmarks, survey-driven mitigation recommendations, GVR methodological proposals, and deterministic verification tooling. The specific empirical contribution is a preregistered, archived paired GVR evaluation under `shared_initial_candidate` semantics that fills a documented gap in artifact-grounded confirmatory assessments of verifier-triggered repair effectiveness.

III. METHODOLOGY

Preregistration and estimand: The experiment followed the preregistered plan `cnsms2026-001-gvr-batfish-prereg-v1` (manifest SHA-256: `46a223492f760950b3d06f475129ce21e52e296c4c2a1e09df3ccd50bec9f891`). The primary estimand is the `paired_success_rate_difference_guarded_minus_baseline` under `shared_initial_candidate` semantics. Under these semantics the identical single sampled initial model candidate per task is used to produce both outcomes: (1) baseline — score the single initial candidate with the deterministic validator; (2) guarded — if that same candidate fails, the pipeline may invoke at most one automated LLM repair call and then rescore with the same deterministic validator. This design isolates the verifier-triggered repair effect for a fixed initial draw and matches the preregistered `execution_contract` (`generation_semantics = "shared_initial_candidate"`).

Task bank, sampling, and inclusion rules: The task bank was deterministically generated to produce $N=300$ intent→CLI pairs, stratified into two vendor-dialect clusters (150 Cisco-like, 150 Juniper-like) via a seeded synthetic generator supplemented with public NetConfEval-style items as specified in the preregistration. Generator ids and deterministic seeds are archived in the task manifest. Inclusion and exclusion rules followed the preregistered contract: public exact-duplicate tasks detected by the contamination check were to be excluded from the primary confirmatory analysis (none were excluded for exact duplication in this run); provider/API transient failures triggered up to two automatic retries, and pairs where both arms failed due to infrastructure/model API errors were excluded from the primary paired analysis per the `'complete_pair_primary'` missingness rule. The execution manifest records `planned_episode_count = 600` ($300 \text{ pairs} \times 2 \text{ arms}$) and `completed_episode_count` and exclusions are reconciled in the deterministic reconciliation artifacts.

Model orchestration and runtime configuration: The declared model used for generation and any repair calls was recorded as `gpt-5-mini` (execution/model_configuration.json declared_model_version = "gpt-5-mini"). Archived configuration fields include `max_output_tokens = 1024`, `maximum_attempts_per_call = 1`, `provider = openai_responses`, and `temperature = null` (unset). Provider accounting recorded `hosted_model_call_event_count = 306`, `completed_hosted_model_call_event_count = 272`, and `failed_hosted_model_call_event_count = 34`; stage accounting recorded `shared_initial_generation = 300` and `repair = 6`. Because temperature was unset and no centralized deterministic sampling seed for provider calls is archived, nondeterministic sampling of provider responses cannot be excluded for the recorded calls; this runtime nondeterminism is declared and discussed in Limitations and the Disclosure Statement.

Deterministic validator design and scoring rules: The binary oracle was `deterministic_netops_validator_v5`. For each candidate it executed a fixed rule battery that is archived per episode: (1) CLI syntactic parsing and normalization; (2) required-sequence checks comparing the task's `required_sequence` to the parsed commands; (3) constrained-field touch checks against `allowed_touched_fields` and `allowed_fields` in the task payload; and (4) reachability/constraint validation over the deterministic synthetic topology model (a lightweight Batfish-style evaluation). Each validator trace archives `validation_before` and `validation_after` objects containing `parsed_command_count`, `required_command_count`, `observed_touched_field_count`, violation codes, `normalized_configuration`, and a boolean valid flag. The confirmatory scoring rule for the primary binary endpoint was `'full_intent_constraint_validation'` as recorded in the scoring artifacts; these artifacts drive the paired contingency counts used in the primary test.

Repair loop mechanics and bounding: Per the preregistration the automated repair stage was strictly bounded to at most one LLM repair call per episode when the initial candidate failed the validator. The repair prompt construction is archived: it includes the task constraints, the validator failure codes and normalized validator diagnostics, and an explicit instruction to produce a corrected configuration satisfying the same task constraints. Repair provider traces and `repair_prompt` identifiers are archived for each repair invocation. Stage accounting indicates 6 repair calls executed in the run; all repair artifacts (repair prompts, repaired outputs, and subsequent validator traces) are included in the evidence bundle and illustrated in representative scoring JSONs.

Analysis plan and inferential procedures: The prespecified primary hypothesis test was the exact McNemar two-sided test on paired binary outcomes at $\alpha=0.05$ (estimator `id` `paired_success_rate_difference_guarded_minus_baseline`). Interval estimation used a paired bootstrap percentile CI ($B=10,000$, `bootstrap_seed = 1729`) for the paired difference to quantify effect magnitude and uncertainty; these bootstrap parameters and resample counts are archived in the

analysis log. Missingness handling for the primary analysis followed the preregistered `'complete_pair_primary'` rule: pairs with both-arm provider/infrastructure failures were excluded from the confirmatory McNemar test; a preregistered sensitivity analysis treats excluded episodes conservatively as failures. Secondary analyses (preregistered) included `median_repair_iterations_per_task` and median end-to-end latency; the latter could not be computed because per-episode timing was not archived. Multiplicity control for formal secondary tests was specified with a Bonferroni adjustment; exploratory analyses were explicitly labeled and not used to support the primary claim.

Execution logging, archival, and auditability: Every episode archived raw model outputs, normalized configurations, `validator_before/after` traces, scorer decision codes, and provider call accounting. Deterministic reconciliation artifacts verify episode accounting (`completed_episode_count`, `failed_episode_count`, `complete_pair_count`) and provider call tallies. Key execution statistics recorded in the reconciliation artifacts are: `planned_episode_count = 600`, `completed_episode_count = 532`, `failed_episode_count = 68`, `complete_pair_count = 266`, `model_calls_used = 306`, `repair_calls = 6`, `cache_hit_count = 0`, `cache_miss_count = 272`. These archived artifacts permit independent verification of the paired counts (`n11`, `n10`, `n01`, `n00`) and replay of repaired episodes for failure-mode inspection.

Design constraints and estimand implications: We emphasize that `shared_initial_candidate` semantics (one sampled initial candidate per task used to evaluate both baseline and guarded outcomes) was selected and executed exactly as preregistered. This choice isolates the incremental effect of a validator-triggered, bounded repair for the observed initial sample; it does not measure the effect of constrained prompting, ensemble first-pass generation, or multiple independent initial draws. Those alternative interventions would require independent-generation arms or additional preregistered conditions that were not executed under this run and therefore are outside the estimand and scope of the reported confirmatory analysis.

IV. RESULTS

Execution accounting and sample construction. The preregistered run planned 600 model-condition episodes ($300 \text{ tasks} \times 2 \text{ conditions}$). The orchestrated pipeline completed 532 episodes and recorded 68 failed episodes (`execution_manifest.json`). After applying preregistered exclusion rules that remove pairs affected by both-arm provider/infrastructure failures, the confirmatory analysis used 266 complete paired units (`analysis/missingness_summary.csv`). Key provider-call accounting from the deterministic reconciliation artifact: `hosted_model_call_event_count = 306` total model call events, of which 272 completed successfully and 34 failed; cache was unused (`cache_hit_count = 0`, `cache_miss_count = 272`). Stage accounting shows that a shared initial generation was produced for every task (`shared_initial_generation = 300`) and

the automated repair stage executed in 6 episodes (repair = 6). All execution-level manifests and per-episode traces are archived to permit replay and audit.

Primary paired outcomes and exact counts. The confirmatory paired contingency (guarded vs baseline) computed on the 266 complete pairs is shown in analysis/paired_contingency_table.csv and summarized here: $n_{11} = 260$ (both baseline and guarded pass), $n_{10} = 5$ (guarded pass, baseline fail), $n_{01} = 0$ (baseline pass, guarded fail), $n_{00} = 1$ (both fail). These margins yield observed success rates baseline = $260/266 = 0.9774436090$ and guarded = $265/266 = 0.9962406015$ with an absolute paired difference of 0.01879699248.

Inferential results: exact McNemar and paired bootstrap CI. Per the preregistered primary test, the exact McNemar two-sided p-value for the observed discordant counts ($n_{10}=5$, $n_{01}=0$) is $p = 0.0625$, which does not meet the preregistered $\alpha = 0.05$ decision rule for rejection. To quantify effect magnitude uncertainty we computed the preregistered paired bootstrap percentile 95% CI with $B = 10,000$ resamples and seed = 1729 (analysis/analysis_log.jsonl); the resulting CI is [0.0037593984962406013, 0.03759398496240601], narrowly excluding zero. Reporting both results preserves the preregistered decision rule while also conveying interval evidence: the discrete nature of McNemar’s exact two-sided test with few discordants can produce conservative p-values even when bootstrap resampling indicates a small positive paired difference with limited sampling variability. Both inferential artifacts (exact p and bootstrap CI with documented seed and resamples) are archived.

Repair invocation behavior and representative repaired episodes. The repair stage executed for 6 of the 300 tasks (stage_counts: repair = 6). Median repair iterations per task across the analysed sample is 0 (majority of tasks required no repair because the shared initial candidate already passed validation). Representative repaired episode: task-000008. The shared initial candidate for task-000008 (execution/responses/task-000008-shared-initial.txt) contained a truncated final token and failed validator checks (validation_before showed parsed_command_count < required_command_count). The automated repair call produced a corrected candidate (execution/responses/task-000008-guarded.txt) whose validator trace (execution/scoring/task-000008-guarded.json) records validation_after.valid = true with no violation codes. Per-episode scoring JSONs record whether a repair was applied, the repair_prompt reference, and the final normalized_configuration accepted by the deterministic validator; all such per-episode repair traces are archived for examination.

Contamination and sensitivity to missingness. The preregistered contamination detector flagged no exact public duplicates (analysis/contamination_summary.csv empty), so no tasks were excluded from the primary analysis on contamination grounds. The preregistered missingness policy excluded 34 both-arm failed episodes from the primary test; a sensitivity analysis that conservatively treats those 34 excluded pairs

as failures (i.e., complete $N = 300$ with both arms set to failure where missing) yields baseline = $260/300 = 0.866667$ and guarded = $265/300 = 0.883333$, but retains the same discordant structure ($n_{10}=5$, $n_{01}=0$) leading to the same exact McNemar $p = 0.0625$. Thus, under the preregistered conservative missingness treatment the formal decision does not change; archived missingness_summary.csv and deterministic_reconciliation.json provide the complete accounting.

Supplementary quantitative artifacts and reproducibility. Analysis artifacts included in the evidence bundle and referenced above provide the reproducible numeric foundations for these results: analysis/condition_summary.csv (baseline: 260 successes, 6 failures; guarded: 265 successes, 1 failure), analysis/paired_contingency_table.csv (n_{11} , n_{10} , n_{01} , n_{00} table), analysis/missingness_summary.csv (counts of excluded and failed episodes), and analysis/analysis_log.jsonl (bootstrap settings: $B=10,000$, seed=1729). deterministic_reconciliation.json documents provider call totals and stage counts that explain model_calls_used = 306 and repair_calls = 6. All files and their hash manifests are archived to enable exact reanalysis or targeted follow-up audits.

V. DISCUSSION

The experiment produced a small absolute improvement in verifier pass-rate when the allowed repair stage could operate on a shared initial candidate: guarded - baseline = 0.01879699248 ($n_{11}=260$, $n_{10}=5$, $n_{01}=0$, $n_{00}=1$). Practically, this pattern—few discordant pairs with all discordance in the guarded→pass direction—indicates that (a) the initial LLM candidate was correct for most tasks in this corpus, and (b) the bounded repair stage occasionally corrected defects that the initial candidate incurred. The artifact accounting (repair calls = 6; hosted_model_call_event_count = 306) confirms repairs were rare relative to total generation activity, explaining the modest absolute gain.

From a statistical perspective the run highlights an important small-sample inference nuance that directly affects operational interpretation. Exact McNemar (two-sided) returned $p = 0.0625$ under the preregistered $\alpha=0.05$ decision rule, while a paired bootstrap percentile CI ($B=10,000$, seed=1729) produced a 95% interval that narrowly excludes zero. These outcomes are consistent: with very few discordant pairs (here 5 vs 0), the exact two-sided McNemar test is discrete and can be conservative; bootstrap resampling of paired differences summarizes empirical variability and can produce a CI excluding zero even when the exact discrete p slightly exceeds 0.05. For readers and practitioners this means that reporting both formal hypothesis outcomes and interval estimates (as archived here) gives a clearer picture: the effect magnitude is small but the CI suggests the effect is positive with narrow uncertainty in the observed corpus, whereas the exact hypothesis test under a strict α threshold does not claim formal rejection.

Operationally, artifact evidence supports three practical inferences grounded in this run. First, when first-pass generator accuracy is high ($\approx 97.7\%$ baseline here), bounded automated

repair offers limited marginal benefit because few failures remain to correct; this is exactly what we observed (6 repair calls on 300 tasks). Second, the marginal utility of GVR will be larger when (i) first-pass accuracy is lower, (ii) verifier coverage detects failure modes common in the target workload, or (iii) the repair mechanism is allowed more than one iteration—conditions not present in this bounded run. Third, the design of the verifier strongly conditions measured benefit: `deterministic_netops_validator_v5` enforces a finite, archived battery of syntactic/sequence/constraint/reachability checks; any semantic failure mode outside that battery is neither detected nor credited to the GVR pipeline. In short, GVR’s measured improvement depends both on how often the generator errs and on whether the verifier can detect the errors that matter operationally.

Threats to inference and external validity remain artifact-grounded. The preregistered `shared_initial_candidate` estimand isolates the effect of validator-triggered repair for a fixed initial sample; it does not measure improvements obtainable by engineering the first pass (e.g., constrained prompting, constrained decoding, or multiple independent draws). Our execution manifest and reconciliation artifacts explicitly record `stage_counts` (`shared_initial_generation` = 300, `repair` = 6) and the lack of independent first-pass generations for separate arms, so extrapolating to comparisons that change initial sampling is unsupported by these artifacts. Missingness also reduced effective sample size: 34 both-arm provider failures were excluded per preregistered rules, lowering precision and power; `deterministic_reconciliation.json` and `analysis/missingness_summary.csv` archive these counts. Finally, per-episode latency was not recorded in per-task artifacts and therefore the preregistered latency secondary estimand could not be evaluated—this absence constrains operational claims about responsiveness or real-time applicability.

Design and research recommendations informed by these artifacts. (1) For stronger causal evidence about prompting or sampling strategies, future preregistrations should include additional independent arms that draw separate initial candidates (`independent_generation` semantics) or include constrained-first-pass prompting; these require separate initial model calls per arm and differ from the `shared_initial_candidate` estimand used here. (2) To assess operational trade-offs, pipeline runs must archive per-episode timing (`generation`→`verification`→`repair`→`final validation`) so latency and throughput can be measured; our provider accounting shows model call counts and failures but not per-episode latencies. (3) Because verifier coverage materially shapes measured benefit, future studies should expand the verifier rule set and publish clear catalogs of detectable failure codes; the per-episode validator traces archived in `execution/scoring/*.json` enable such audits and should be exploited to extend verifier coverage and to quantify verifier false negatives. (4) When baseline pass rates are high, consider targeting task corpora with intentionally lower baseline accuracy

(e.g., out-of-distribution intents, noisier prompts, or reduced grounding) to increase discordant counts and thereby statistical power to detect repair benefits.

Concluding synthesis: the archived artifacts show that a bounded GVR pipeline can correct occasional deterministic-validator failures for a fixed initial candidate, but when the generator’s first-pass accuracy is already high and the verifier’s coverage is finite, the absolute operational improvement is small. The run’s reconciled accounting, validator traces, repair provider traces, and contamination checks (no exact public duplicates flagged) provide a reproducible empirical substrate for these conclusions and for follow-on experiments that expand sampling semantics, verifier coverage, or repair budgets.

VI. LIMITATIONS

- `Shared_initial_candidate` semantics: both arms used the same single sampled initial candidate per preregistration; the estimand measures validator-triggered repair benefit for that fixed initial sample and does not evaluate independent first-pass generations or constrained first-pass prompting strategies.
- Missingness and sample reduction: planned $N=300$ pairs; after infrastructure/provider exclusions 266 pairs were complete and 34 both-arm episodes were excluded per preregistered rules, reducing effective sample size and precision.
- Small discordant counts: primary inference used exact McNemar with few discordants ($n_{10}=5$, $n_{01}=0$); conclusions are sensitive to inferential choice and limited power.
- Validator coverage: `deterministic_netops_validator_v5` enforces a finite set of syntactic/semantic/reachability rules; semantic violations outside its coverage are possible and unmeasured.
- Runtime nondeterminism and sampling: archived `execution/model_configuration.json` records `temperature` = null and no deterministic seed; nondeterministic sampling cannot be excluded for recorded model calls.
- H2 latency not evaluated: per-episode end-to-end latency was not present in archived per-task artifacts and therefore the preregistered latency bound (median ≤ 60 s) could not be assessed.
- External validity: task corpus derives from public NetConfEval-style examples and a seeded synthetic generator limited to two vendor-dialect clusters; results do not imply universal benefit across other vendors, larger topologies, or production deployments.

VII. CONCLUSION

We executed a preregistered paired experiment that evaluated a GVR pipeline (`gpt-5-mini` + `deterministic_netops_validator_v5` + ≤ 1 automated repair) on `intent`→`CLI` tasks under `shared_initial_candidate` semantics. Across 266 analysed pairs the guarded pipeline improved validator pass rate by 0.01879699248 but did not meet the preregistered exact-McNemar $\alpha=0.05$ decision rule

($p=0.0625$); a paired bootstrap CI ($B=10,000$, $\text{seed}=1729$) narrowly excludes zero. Repair calls were rare (6/300) and median repair iterations per task = 0. Per-episode latency was not archived and could not be assessed. All execution and analysis artifacts (raw responses, validator traces, provider call accounting, and reconciliation manifests) are archived in the evidence bundle to support reanalysis and follow-on work.

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DISCLOSURE STATEMENT

Disclosure (concise): Declared model: gpt-5-mini (execution/model_configuration.json archived; declared_model_version = "gpt-5-mini"). Orchestration adapter: hosted_netops_gvr_v1. Deterministic validator: deterministic_netops_validator_v5. Preregistration: cnsm2026-001-gvr-batfish-prereg-v1 (manifest SHA-256: 46a223492f760950b3d06f475129ce21e52e296c4c2a1e09df3ccd50bec9f891). Initial master prompt immutable reference: provenance/master_prompt.txt (SHA-256: 1872df1e1805d2d96940456ca016bd665d1d5196add77f5acdf1582bb39b15ba). Human role and autonomy boundary: before the autonomy lock a human Research Director selected the topic family and approved pre-lock infrastructure development; after the autonomy lock the registered pipeline autonomously performed literature selection, preregistration, experimental execution, analysis, manuscript drafting, AI peer review simulation, and revision. Nondeterminism disclosure: archived execution/model_configuration.json records temperature = null (unset) and no deterministic sampling seed is archived; therefore nondeterministic sampling of model outputs cannot be excluded for the recorded provider calls. Execution and analysis artifacts, logs, and hash manifests are archived in the evidence bundle referenced in the preregistration.

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